



VISUAL IDENTITY & DESIGN SYSTEM

Brand Style Guide

Marketing Standards for WorkforceAP

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HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

This document defines visual and verbal standards for all WorkforceAP marketing — website, social media, collateral, presentations, and partner communications. When in doubt: use the token system, not hardcoded values.

Brand Identity

Mission, positioning, and personality.

MISSION STATEMENT

Connecting underserved adults, the organizations that serve them, and the employers that need them — in one verified closed loop.

Free to members. Employer-aligned. Outcome-accountable.

BRAND PERSONALITY

Trait	Meaning
Grounded	Show outcomes, not promises.
Direct	Plain language. No jargon.
Warm	This is someone's livelihood.
Ambitious	Infrastructure, not a charity.
Inclusive	No age gate. No degree. No exclusion.

WHAT MAKES US DIFFERENT

We Are	We're Not
Free to all qualifying members	Employer-sponsored only
Adults 18+ at any career stage	Recent grads only
Verified placement + 180-day tracking	Certificate mill
Full-stack AI platform	PDF worksheets

Color System

WCAG AA compliant. All backgrounds hardcoded for consistency.

PRIMARY PALETTE

			
Crimson (Accent) #AD2C4D CTAs, links, all accent uses	Gold #FFBB00 Dark bg only — fails on light	Near Black #121416 Hero bg, dark surfaces	White #FFFFFF Text on dark, light surfaces

SUPPORTING PALETTE

			
Accent Dark #8B1F38 Hover state for Crimson	Blue #2B7BB9 Links, informational states	Green #4A9B4F Success, positive metrics	On Surface Var. #584144 Secondary text, labels

✓ CRIMSON IS THE SOLE CTA COLOR

One primary action per view. Always #AD2C4D. Never swap to another color.

✗ GOLD FAILS ON LIGHT BACKGROUNDS

Gold on white = 1.7:1 contrast. Use Gold on dark (#121416) surfaces only.

✓ USE CSS TOKENS IN CODE

```
var(--color-accent) not #AD2C4D  
var(--color-gold) not #FFBB00
```

✗ NEVER USE VAR(--COLOR-WHITE) ON HERO TEXT

In dark mode, --color-white remaps to #121417 (near-black). Use literal #fff on dark overlays.

Typography

Inter is our single typeface. Hierarchy through weight and size.

Display/H1
40px · 800

Empowering People.

H2
32px · 700

Industry-Recognized Certifications

H3
24px · 700

Digital Literacy Program

Body
16px · 400 ·
1.6lh

Free career training for adults at every stage of their journey. Our programs are employer-aligned and outcome-accountable.

Small
14px · 400

Duration: 3–6 months · Cost to member: \$0 · CompTIA certified

LINE HEIGHT

Body: **1.6×**

Headings: **1.0–1.2×**

LETTER SPACING

Display: **-0.03em**

Labels: **+0.06–0.15em**

LINE WIDTH

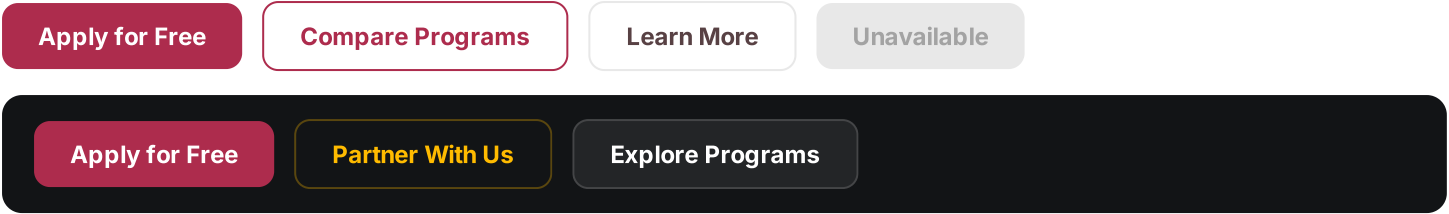
Body: **65–70 chars**

Max: **~680px**

Buttons & CTAs

One primary action per view. Specific copy.

BUTTON VARIANTS



CTA COPY RULES

✓ Write This	✗ Not This
Apply for Free	Learn More
Start My Application	Click Here
Compare Programs	Submit
Partner With Us	Explore Opportunities

BUTTON HIERARCHY

Type	When
Primary	One per screen — main conversion
Secondary	Supporting actions
Ghost	Tertiary, nav items
Gold (dark)	Secondary CTA on dark heroes only

Logo Usage

Never stretched. Never recolored. Always with clear space.



On white / light backgrounds



On dark / photo backgrounds



On accent (crimson) backgrounds

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Rule	Standard
Clear Space	Min 1× height of "W" letterform on all sides
Min Size	120px wide (digital) / 1 inch (print)
On Light	Full color — crimson icon, dark wordmark
On Dark	White version — never use color logo on dark
Never	Stretch, skew, recolor, add shadow, crop below 120px

Voice & Copy

Plain. Direct. Human. Specific.

✓ DIRECT

"Apply now. We respond within 3–5 business days."

✓ SPECIFIC

"CompTIA A+, IBM AI Professional, \$62K–\$88K starting."

✗ CORPORATE

"We'd love to connect on your exciting journey forward!"

✗ VAGUE

"Industry-recognized certs in high-demand fields."

TERMINOLOGY STANDARDS

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✓ Use This	✗ Not This	Reason
Member	Student / User	Adults in a community, not students.
Free / \$0	Complimentary	Say it plainly. Asterisks create distrust.
WorkforceAP	WAP / Workforce AP	One word, camel case. Always.

Quick Reference

All rules. One page.

PRIMARY CTA COLOR

Crimson #AD2C4D — always. One per screen.

HERO TEXT

Use #fff directly on dark overlays — not `var(--color-white)`.

SPACING

8px grid. CSS tokens only — no arbitrary values.

BORDER RADIUS

Buttons: 8px · Cards: 12px · Modals: 16px.

LOGO CLEAR SPACE

1× height of 'W' on all sides. Min 120px wide.

DARK MODE CODE

Use `var()` tokens — never hardcode hex in components.

GOLD USAGE

Dark backgrounds only. Never on white/light (fails WCAG).

FONT

Inter only. Body 16px/1.6. Headings Bold 700.

CONTRAST

4.5:1 body, 3:1 large text/UI (WCAG AA minimum).

MOBILE

<640px: single column, 44px touch targets, bottom nav.

CTA COPY

"Apply for Free" > "Learn More" — specific + active voice.

TERMINOLOGY

"Member" not "student". "WorkforceAP" not "WAP".

Questions about the brand?

Design system: `workforceap-beta/css/main.css`

